Name each force and its source

LEARNING TARGET · K2 I can name each force, its source and its receiver.

A · KEY VOCABULARY

Weight W	Earth's downward pull: mg.
Normal N	Surface push, perpendicular to contact.
Tension T	Rope's pull along itself, away from the object.
Receiver	The object a force acts on; also name its source.

B · KEY EQUATIONS + UNITS

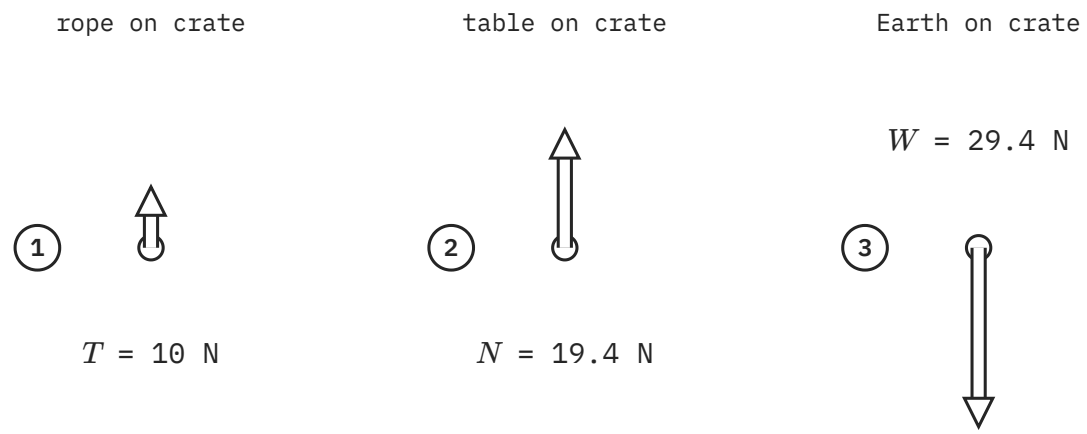
$$W = mg$$

$$N + T - W = 0$$

g	**9.8 N/kg**
balance	vertical $a = 0$

C · COLOR IT · ONE CRATE, THREE FORCES

A rope helps a table.



Three forces; one receiver. The crate stays at rest.

- ☐ **1 · ORANGE** Rope's tension T
- ☐ **2 · ORANGE** Table's normal N
- ☐ **3 · ORANGE** Earth's weight W

D · WORKED EXAMPLE

A **3 kg** crate rests on a table. A vertical rope pulls up with **10 N**. **Find the table's normal force.** Use g = **9.8 N/kg**.

GIVEN	EQUATION	WORK	ANSWER
m = **3 kg** T = **10 N** up a_y = 0	$W = mg$. $N + T - W = 0$.	W = 3(9.8) = **29.4 N** N = 29.4 − 10	N = **19.4 N** The rope shares the support.

E · THE 2026-XJ THREAD

DAY 10 OF 22 · NEW TOOL: FORCE SOURCES

A forecast of XJ's changing motion needs real interactions, not a made-up motion force. Name the attracting body for each gravitational force before adding the forces.

Unit question: How fast is it moving, and where will it arrive?

UNIT 1 COLOR CODE ☐ green speeding up ☐ red slowing down ☐ yellow steady · balanced ☐ blue position · displacement ☐ purple velocity ☐ orange forces pencil · everything else

Every force has a source and a receiver

Weight, normal force, tension, and supported objects

Before we add forces, we need to know which forces belong in the calculation. A useful habit is to name both the object receiving a force and the object exerting it. “The rope pulls on the crate” identifies an interaction. “The crate is moving” describes its motion, but does not identify a new force. I want each arrow to have a physical source.

Weight is the gravitational force Earth exerts on an object. Near Earth's surface, its magnitude is $W = mg$. Mass is measured in kilograms; weight is measured in newtons. We use $g = 9.8\ \text{N/kg}$, meaning each kilogram has 9.8 N of gravitational force acting on it in this model. The same value can be expressed as 9.8 m/s² when describing free-fall acceleration.

The normal force comes from contact with a surface and acts perpendicular to that surface. Tension comes from a taut rope and pulls along the rope, away from the object. Neither force is automatically equal to weight. Its magnitude depends on the other forces and on the object's acceleration. A surface and a rope can share the job of supporting an object.

Consider the **3 kg crate** resting on a level table while a vertical rope pulls upward with **10 N**. Earth's downward pull is $W = (3\ \text{kg})(9.8\ \text{N/kg}) = 29.4\ \text{N}$. The table pushes upward with a normal force whose magnitude we have not yet found. There are three forces on the crate: weight, tension, and the normal force.

The crate stays at rest, so its vertical acceleration is zero. Choose upward as positive. The force equation is $N + T - W = 0$. Substituting gives $N + 10\ \text{N} - 29.4\ \text{N} = 0$, so $N = 19.4\ \text{N}$. Here italic N represents the normal-force magnitude; upright N after a number is the unit newton. The rope supplies part of the upward support, leaving the table to supply the rest.

In the diagram, all three arrows act on the same chosen object. Orange identifies force. If the arrows use one consistent scale, the two upward lengths together should match the downward length. The normal arrow should be longer than the tension arrow, but shorter than the weight arrow. That picture is a useful check on the numbers and the balance equation.

If the rope were absent and the crate remained at rest, the normal force would equal the weight. That equality follows from the particular situation; it is not the definition of a normal force. An inclined surface or an additional vertical force changes the calculation. Likewise, mass remains the same when support changes, even though a scale's reading can change.

For our fictional asteroid, 2026-XJ, we will name the source of every proposed force before using it. Gravity can act without contact. A rope, supporting surface, or engine force belongs only when that interaction exists. A clear list of sources and receivers prevents us from inventing forces simply to match the motion we expect.